

Topline Academy Beginner Guide

This beginner guide walks you through the Topline Academy MVP setup, architecture, core flows, and service integrations.

1. Overview

Topline Academy is a Next.js 14 app built for live and recorded class management.

It supports role-based dashboards for students, instructors, and admins.

The app uses JWT cookie authentication, Prisma for PostgreSQL access, Resend for email, and Daily for embedded video sessions.

2. Local setup

Prerequisites

- Node.js 20+ / npm
- PostgreSQL or Supabase database
- A code editor like VS Code
- Optional: Vercel account for deployment

Install dependencies

```
bash
npm install
```

Configure environment

Copy the example file and update values:

```
bash
cp .env.example .env
```

Set the following values in `.env`:

- `DATABASE_URL` — PostgreSQL connection string`
- `JWT_SECRET` — secret for signing session tokens`
- `RESEND_API_KEY` — Resend API key for outgoing email`
- `SUPABASE_URL` — Supabase project URL`

- ``SUPABASE_ANON_KEY`` — Supabase public key
- ``SUPABASE_SERVICE_KEY`` — Supabase service role key
- ``DAILY_API_KEY`` — Daily.co API key
- ``NEXT_PUBLIC_DAILY_DOMAIN`` — Daily domain, e.g. ``toplineacademy.daily.co``
- ``NEXT_PUBLIC_DAILY_ROOM`` — default Daily room name

Generate Prisma client

```
bash
```

```
npm run prisma:generate
```

Start development server

```
bash
```

```
npm run dev
```

Open the app at: ``http://localhost:3000`` or the port shown by Next.js.

3. Project structure

- ``src/app`` — Next.js App Router pages and API routes
- ``src/components`` — shared UI components
- ``src/lib`` — helper utilities and database connectors
- ``prisma/schema.prisma`` — database models
- ``docs/`` — project documentation and screenshots

4. Authentication and session flow

Topline Academy uses JWT cookies for session management.

Key files

- ``src/lib/auth.ts`` — password hashing and JWT token utilities
- ``src/lib/get-session.ts`` — reads the ``topline_session`` cookie and verifies JWT
- ``src/app/api/auth/register/route.ts`` — registers new users
- ``src/app/api/auth/login/route.ts`` — logs users in and sets the cookie
- ``src/app/api/auth/me/route.ts`` — returns authenticated user info
- ``src/app/api/auth/logout/route.ts`` — clears the session cookie

Roles

The app supports three roles:

- `STUDENT`
- `INSTRUCTOR`
- `ADMIN`

The role is stored in the JWT payload and used for UI flow and API authorization.

5. How enrollment works

Students browse classes in `/classes` and open class details.

If a student is not logged in, the UI prompts them to login or register.

When a student clicks `Enroll now`, the app calls:

- `POST /api/classes/[id]/enroll`

That endpoint verifies the session and the `STUDENT` role.

If the student is already enrolled, the request is rejected.

After enrollment, the request is saved with status `PENDING`.

Admins can approve or reject enrollments from the admin dashboard.

6. Admin service health checks

A health endpoint is available at:

- `GET /api/health`

The admin dashboard also displays integration status for:

- `database`
- `resend`
- `daily`

This is useful to confirm the required environment variables are configured.

7. Screenshots

Home page:

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Classes page:

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Login page:

[Image not loaded: docs\./screenshots/login.png]

8. Key pages

- ``/`` — landing page
- ``/classes`` — class catalog
- ``/classes/[id]`` — class detail and enrollment
- ``/login`` — login page
- ``/register`` — registration page
- ``/dashboard/student`` — student dashboard
- ``/dashboard/instructor`` — instructor dashboard
- ``/admin`` — admin dashboard

9. Common maintenance tasks

Reset Prisma schema

```
bash
npm run prisma:migrate
```

Rebuild the app

```
bash
npm run build
```

Verify TypeScript

```
bash
npx tsc --noEmit
```

10. Notes for next improvements

- Add actual Daily room creation from the server using the Daily API
- Wire email notifications for enrollment events

- Add tests for key auth and API flows
- Harden role-based route protection on the server
- Add payment proof upload and approval workflow

This document is a quick starter guide for onboarding new developers into the Topline Academy project.